



MONTHLY UPDATE

Legislation and regulation: monthly update, August 2026

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39 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

ALGERIA · ANGOLA · BURUNDI · CAMEROON · CAPE VERDE · CHAD · COTE D'IVOIRE · DR CONGO · EGYPT · EQUATORIAL GUINEA · ESWATINI · ETHIOPIA · GABON · GAMBIA · GHANA · GUINEA · KENYA · LESOTHO · LIBERIA · MADAGASCAR · MALAWI · MALI · MAURITIUS · MOROCCO · MOZAMBIQUE · NAMIBIA · NIGER · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SENEGAL · SIERRA LEONE · SOMALIA · SOUTH AFRICA · SOUTH SUDAN · SUDAN · TANZANIA · TOGO · UGANDA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

The electronic commerce law is in force and, on a consumer body's assessment, largely bypassed: [the great majority of online selling runs through social-media pages outside its obligations, with cash on delivery dominant](#). That is named-analyst opinion rather than a state position; the law's own date and text are not held, and no enforcement action or compliance figure is on file. Separately a [national information-verification system was examined in draft by the Council of Government on 23 July](#), with no regulator, legal basis or oversight mechanism named in anything held. On 14 August the telecommunications ministry [asked Meta to require every WhatsApp account to stay linked to a verified national mobile number](#), rejecting the username-only accounts introduced in June 2026 and citing fraud, identity theft and cybercrime prevention. It is a request rather than an instrument; no order, deadline or sanction is stated, and the platform-regulation bill deposited in October 2025 remains undebated.

Angola

The cybersecurity bill re-entered detailed consideration. Three specialised committees met jointly on 3 August and [voted it chapter by chapter](#) on three axes — drafting, systematisation and harmonisation — all presented as preserving the substance approved in generality in January 2026 on 105 votes for, one against and 75 abstentions. Deputies had suspended the same discussion on 7 and 8 July over drafting non-conformities in the preamble and first two chapters, one party warning that a redraft that deep might require a wholly new bill.

Five days before that vote, the country's own delegation told a regional forum in Lusaka on 29 July that its cybersecurity law was still in a diagnostic phase. Both statements are the government's own.

The bill then passed. The National Assembly [adopted it on 12 August by 104 votes to 56](#), the governing party for and the opposition against with no abstentions, on a text of presidential initiative directed at protecting networks, critical infrastructure and essential services through prevention, detection, incident response and restoration. The penalties are administrative and graduated: [seven to 70 minimum wages for individuals on the lightest infringements, rising to 500 for individuals and 4,000 for legal persons on the most serious](#). No promulgation, gazette number or entry-into-force date is on file.

What the vote settles and what it leaves open are different things. The law [requires telecommunications operators to transmit any communication whose content is criminal or prejudicial to state security](#), and the opposition and part of civil society object that neither the qualifying content nor the circumstances in which a subscriber's personal data reaches the authorities is defined — a lawyer quoted in the same account gives the circulation of a call to demonstrate as an example that might qualify. The vote came a year before the presidential election, days after the online-falsehoods law entered into force, and weeks after the cyberattack on the incumbent operator that the governing party cited for it.

The National Assembly [approved legislative authorisation 166 votes to nil on 30 July](#) for the President to legislate an electronic-signature and digital-certification regime, valid 90 days after publication of the enabling law — so the regime defining an accrediting authority, a root certification entity and the evidential weight of a signature will be an executive instrument, grounded on the insufficiency of two 2011 texts.

The national cybersecurity centre, whose statute was published in December 2025, is still described in the future tense by the minister responsible: on 10 August he [said it would be launched during 2026](#) to monitor digital threats, defend critical infrastructure and coordinate incident response.

Burundi

An [access-to-information bill is on the National Assembly's order paper for the session opened at the Kigobe Congress Palace on 3 August 2026](#). The first vice-president listed it among the bills the chamber will examine. Article 176 caps ordinary sessions at three months, putting the outer bound for passage in this sitting at roughly end-October 2026. No text, tabling number, sponsoring ministry or timetable was published and no copy is held — the announcement establishes only that the bill exists and is scheduled. Burundi has had no access-to-information statute on file to date.

The ministry opened consultations on the country's first dedicated framework for online publishing. A workshop on 26 August [gathered influencers, content creators, legal experts and jurists for sector input before a bill regulating social-media influencers and content creators is finalised](#); no draft provisions are published, and whether the law would require registration, set disclosure rules for sponsored content, create an oversight body or set penalties is unestablished.

Cameroon

The one legislative act in the window changes the regulator rather than the rules it applies. A finance ministry order [moved the telecoms regulator from the third to the second category of public establishments, on its average realised budget across the 2022, 2023 and 2024 financial years](#). The category governs institutional standing and pay structure, so what moved is the regulator's own position in the state rather than any power it holds over the sector. Neither the order text nor the budget figures behind it are published.

Cape Verde

The regulator [opened a public consultation on licensing, spectrum use, frequency coordination, user protection, network security and emergency communications for satellite operators, with submissions to 31 August](#). It is a direct response to the satellite service launched in the archipelago in December 2024, and is distinct from the general-authorisation regime under which that service was licensed. No draft text or adoption date is published.

Chad

Chad's digital statutes entered the base this month by being listed, not by being made. The regulator's register [names the 2015 laws on cybersecurity, electronic transactions and personal data protection as the laws it works under](#) and links the text of none; the statistics institute [names Loi n. 026/PR/2019 and four decrees](#).

On payments there is nothing national to name at all: the central bank's register [gives the regional payment systems regulation of December 2016 as the instrument in force](#). A payments law that is regional and a practice that runs on conventions with four operators leave no statute a citizen can be pointed to.

Cote d'Ivoire

The cyber-security agency is [operating a national security operations centre, a public-administration security-officer network, the national public key infrastructure and auditor certification against the state reference framework](#), resting on the 2013 electronic transactions law whose 2014 and 2016 implementing decrees are the stated legal basis for that infrastructure — the only Ivorian digital statute the base can name implementing decrees for. Against that, [no Ivorian artificial-intelligence statute is published](#): governance runs entirely through non-binding strategy instruments, with the draft cybersecurity strategy the only binding-track vehicle extending state scope to it.

The one place where a statute is acquiring machinery is consumer redress. The regulator [consulted operators, internet service providers and consumer associations on 13 and 14 August on a draft procedure for handling consumer complaints about electronic communications services](#), implementing the 2024 electronic communications law. No draft text, adoption date or redress standard is held.

The regulator [validated a harmonised procedure for handling consumer complaints](#) against operators and internet service providers, now to be transmitted to its Conseil de regulation for possible adoption.

DR Congo

The [interministerial order on digital-sector duties, taxes and fees was in force on signature on 20 July under its article 5](#). It sets a [two-tier dollar schedule keyed to whether a provider is judged dominant, running from US\\$2,500 to US\\$15,000 for cloud services and US\\$25,000 to US\\$100,000 for data-centre declaration, with one startup line at US\\$100](#). It was [suspended by government communiqué on 3 August](#). Neither the gazetted order nor the suspending communiqué is held.

Two regulators agreed on 22 July to [form joint inspection teams and enforce local-content subcontracting rules on large operators](#), scoped beyond telecoms to digital services and e-commerce; no written protocol is held.

The digital code is being applied to speech. On 15 August the justice minister [restated the government's determination to clean up Congolese cyberspace and said prosecutions were already under way for public insults and defamation on social platforms under the Code du numérique](#), after receiving an NGO memorandum on 13 August. No case number, charge or judgment is held.

A new schedule of [taxes, permits and sanctions now governs the digital sphere](#). The base holds a legal analysis of it rather than the instrument, so the issuing authority, the instrument number and the entry-into-force date are not established here.

Egypt

A cabinet meeting chaired by the Prime Minister agreed on 29 July 2026 to review the statutes governing social media and to raise financial penalties, with the ICT ministry preparing a comparative study of other states' regimes. In the same meeting the minister disclosed that a unit inside the telecommunications regulator already detects and acts on artificial-intelligence-manipulated video and imagery, and said that legislative amendment is still needed to address the practices at root ([cabinet account](#)). The unit's formation date, legal basis, staffing, method and appeal route were not stated.

Nine days earlier a member of parliament had called for a comprehensive standalone digital-privacy bill criminalising the recording and publication of people without consent, imposing takedown duties on platforms and widening investigators' powers to trace anonymous accounts, arguing that the Cybercrime Law and the Penal Code are insufficient in practice. The demand does not refer to the Personal Data Protection Law of 2020 at any point ([demand](#)).

A third route opened on 10 August, outside both: a party draft, described by its sponsor as [fifty-four articles over seven chapters, would require platforms to appoint a legal representative in the country, register influencers on a national platform, and regulate artificial intelligence, deepfakes, online extortion, gambling and child protection online](#). It has not been tabled and no text is published.

On 4 August the Ministry of Justice gazetted a deferral of the title-based property register for one Sohag survey section by a year to July 2027.

Equatorial Guinea

The full text of the 2024 social media and computer crime law reached the base this month: it [criminalises computer fraud, identity theft and false news online](#) and creates the national cybersecurity agency the ledger has carried as an entity with no premises, staffing or budget on record. The government [reasserted the law's full force on 1 July amid rising complaints, naming neither artificial intelligence nor deepfakes](#). Alongside it the information minister [presented a press-law reform bill on 6 August regulating digital media and cable television for the first time](#), now under committee review with no adoption date and no bill text published. The Chamber of Deputies' own account of the sitting shows it was not presented alone: [a separate Copyright and Related Rights bill went to the chamber the same day](#), implementing Equatorial Guinea's 1997 Berne Convention accession and its 2015 Bangui Agreement obligations under OAPI, so the copyright provisions are a companion instrument rather than part of the audiovisual bill.

Eswatini

In the same 4 August answer, the ICT ministry said it had completed the Online Media Publishing Guidelines 2026, introducing a registration requirement for online publishers bound to accuracy, privacy protection, child safeguarding and the responsible use of AI. Neither the text nor a commencement date is public.

Ethiopia

Three instruments moved in the window and none binds yet. The Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Proclamation was [signed by the President at Addis Ababa on 21 July, designating twelve critical sectors, placing eighteen core obligations on owners and operators and creating a cybersecurity fund](#), with commencement set one year after gazettment “about July 2027” and regulation-making powers left to the Council of Ministers and the security agency. On copyright, a [draft ratification proclamation for the Berne Convention went to the Council of Ministers](#),

and a separate amendment to the 2004 copyright proclamation is being drafted with a university law school to add internet service provider duties, site-blocking procedures and a rights-holder take-down notice. Ethiopia is not yet a party to the convention and neither draft has a published text.

Gabon

On 11 July nine civil-society organisations declared the broadcasting authority's social-media suspension unconstitutional, disproportionate and beyond its statutory remit, and demanded its abrogation; they also stated that a bill regulating social media exists and awaits promulgation ([declaration](#)). On 17 July the presidential spokesman defended the measure as temporary and conservatory and gave no lifting date. On 25 July an advocacy association presented a report built from two months of consultations, finding no transparent mechanism governing restriction of social networks and recommending revision of the ordinance of 8 April 2026 and greater independence for the broadcasting authority ([report](#)). On 13 August the national human-rights and democracy council took the opposite side of the same argument, [calling for judicial action against online outrage of the presidency and urging a CEMAC or continental legal framework for cyberspace modelled on the European Union's Digital Services Act](#).

On 23 July a national workshop validated by consensus five implementing texts on the digitalisation of teaching — two decrees, two orders and a decree creating a basic computing certificate — and forwarded them to the competent authorities with recommendations. They are technically validated and not adopted ([close of the workshop](#)).

The month's other legislative movement is procedural rather than expressive. A justice ministry commission [submitted a draft Code of Civil Procedure on 11 August](#), a rewrite of the 1977 ordinance running to more than 800 pages that would let procedural filings be made and held electronically, introduce secure digital tools, and harmonise with the OHADA uniform acts. Professional consultation and parliamentary debate are still ahead, and the draft text is not held.

An earlier instrument reached the base this month and it is the furthest-going measure of its kind reported in the region. An ordinance of February 2026 [fixes digital majority at 16 and obliges platforms to limit certain publication and interaction functions, to disable contacts from unidentified users by default and to provide age-verification mechanisms](#) — a duty on how a platform is built rather than a minimum age alone, where Rwanda is still preparing a restriction on under-16s and Zimbabwe has gone the policy route. The ordinance text is not held, only a comparative account of it, and no implementing regulation, supervisory body or enforcement action is on record.

The primary text of the social-media ordinance arrived, and it settles a conflation the base had carried. [Ordonnance n 0011/PR/2026](#), signed on 26 February 2026 and published in Journal Officiel n 110 of 8 April 2026, is the instrument the base had recorded twice — once as an ordinance whose text was not held and once as a bill reported second-hand to be awaiting promulgation. It runs to fifty-five articles in eleven chapters: digital majority is fixed at sixteen and account creation below it barred; editors must block publication, sharing and social-interaction functions for accounts identified as under-sixteen without recorded parental consent, disable by default any function letting unidentified persons contact a minor, filter algorithmic recommendation of violent, sexual or psychologically harmful AI content to minor accounts, and report quarterly to the competent authority; age-verification systems sit under a Haute Autorite de la Communication reference framework and a technical audit; and the *refere numerique* caps any temporary suspension of access to a platform at seventy-two hours. The twelve-month compliance clock runs from publication, to 8 April 2027.

Gabon also [brought non-resident digital platforms within Value Added Tax and the Contribution Speciale de Solidarite](#) through its 2026 supplementary finance law, reaching foreign streaming and platform services. No registration threshold, collection mechanism or first receipt is on file.

Gambia

An Act already in force showed what passing one is worth on its own: the press union reported on 7 August that [most public institutions have yet to appoint the information officers the Access to Information Act requires, and that twenty-one-day requests go unanswered](#). No government response, compliance count or enforcement action is on record. The Communications Bill 2025, meanwhile, stayed in committee. Two Assembly committees [met the Press Union and the Media Council on 18 July 2026](#); the Union set out the media laws it wants repealed alongside the bill, and members said they could take stakeholder views into committee but not debate it publicly.

A second instrument was validated on [31 July 2026: the State Intelligence Service Bill](#), at a workshop attended by the National Security Adviser, the Chief of Defence Staff, the Assembly's defence committee and civil society. The Adviser said the draft prohibits torture, unlawful detention and political targeting, requires judicial warrants and oversight for intrusive measures, and gives the Assembly review of the Service's budgets. Its threat frame is cybercrime, espionage, disinformation and organised crime, so it is where Gambian communications interception would sit. The text is not held, the Bill has not been tabled, and it does not appear in the Assembly's bills library, checked 2026-08-08.

Ghana

The ministry took industry comment on 27 July on the [draft digital economy and innovation development fund bill](#); the levy rate and governance structure are unestablished, and the draft is not published. Speaking at an artificial-intelligence summit on 29 July, the ministry named a data harmonisation Act and a proposed data exchange Act as the enabling layer under a ten-year implementation plan — the first mention on file of an exchange statute distinct from harmonisation, and neither has a published draft.

Guinea

Two instruments were made and a third process opened. The President [signed the implementing decree for electronic signatures on 19 August](#), and the government [opened a workshop on three bills consolidating the legal framework of the public administration](#). Neither the decree text nor the bills are published, so their scope cannot be read off the record.

Kenya

Virtual-asset regulations were [gazetted on 22 July 2026 as Legal Notice 134](#), setting paid-up capital by licence class from KES 300m for stablecoin issuance to nil for investment advisers, and a seizure and freezing framework; the draft's ownership cap did not survive into the gazetted text. Existing operators must license afresh by 4 November 2026 under the 2025 Act.

On 28 July the Court of Appeal's narrowing of the Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act was [reported at a coalition close-out](#): the false-publication sections and the power to shut down websites without judicial oversight were struck, and a conservatory order blocks a national internet shutdown pending full hearing.

On 31 August the National Assembly was reported to have [asked the Supreme Court to restore sections 22 and 23](#), which punished the intentional publication of false, misleading or fictitious data presented as authentic and the knowing spread of false information liable to cause panic, chaos or violence or to damage a reputation, with fines of up to KES 5m and, for some offences, up to ten years' imprisonment. The Court of Appeal had held the wording too broad, catching users who share false content without knowing it is false along with journalists and people expressing opinions; Parliament's case is that the sections reach neither opinion, satire nor good-faith error, only knowing publication presented as authentic. The narrowing is therefore contested rather than settled.

Cyber cafés acquired licence conditions and then a clarification of them. The conditions came in [Gazette Notice 12180 of 7 August 2026](#), which sets licence conditions for two categories under a revised telecommunications market structure – Public Communications Access Centre and Communications Equipment Vendor – after public consultation, effective 30 days from the notice; the same page carries a second notice covering five further categories, among them Network Facilities Provider Tier 2 and Tier 3 and International Gateway Systems and Services, so the market structure is being licensed category by category rather than in one instrument. The access-centre conditions require [customer name and identity number](#), [terminal and session times](#) to be captured and kept at least three years, taking effect on 7 September, and the regulator [clarified on 13 August](#) that operators need not track customers' browsing history. An earlier account of the same rules gave the effective date as 14 August; the gazette notice the regulator cites puts it four weeks later.

A separate bill would meter what those records cover. An internet service provider [told Parliament on 14 August](#) that mandatory consumption-based internet billing under the Kenya Information and Communications (Amendment) Bill 2025 could raise costs and create data-privacy risks, metering at subscriber level implying retained usage records. No committee report or enactment date is published.

The intellectual-property bill acquired its shape in public. Parliament [invited submissions on a draft](#) that would merge the industrial property institute, the copyright board and the anti-counterfeit authority into a single regulator, replace the 2001 and 2008 statutes, and set rules distinguishing AI-assisted from AI-generated inventions.

Lesotho

No instrument was made, gazetted or brought into force in this window. [Reporting of the CSIRT launch](#) discloses that the Computer Crime and Cybersecurity Bill has been split into a Cybercrime Bill and a Cybersecurity Bill, both awaiting National Assembly approval, and the ministerial reference to a national cybersecurity strategy that the wiki does not hold.

Liberia

The same package, [set out on 17 July](#), covers a split of infrastructure and service licences with rural incentives, tower-sharing rules, the country's first satellite regulations, an IMEI anti-theft regime and repatriation of the .lr country domain. None has been published as an instrument.

One piece of it is now a signed instrument. The regulator [signed satellite communications guidelines on 19 August](#), after a consultation that ran from February to June, and the text sets five-year non-geostationary and ten-year geostationary landing rights, a US\$250,000 direct-to-device service-provider licence fee with 9% of direct-to-device sales and a 0.5% universal-access contribution, mandatory data-protection and cybersecurity compliance plans, and a twelve-month transition for operators already here. No licence has yet been issued under it on the record.

Madagascar

The extraordinary session ended without passing a digital law. The National Assembly [deferred five bills to a later session on 4 September, the recast cybercrime law and the electronic communications and digital infrastructure bill first among them](#), the deputies saying they needed longer on texts turning on both security imperatives and fundamental freedoms and the Assembly's president saying he did not care to imagine what would have followed had they not deferred. The cybercrime bill would create a digital protection and investigation unit and, under article 75, give it permanent round-the-clock technical access to operators' systems; [commentary reads the contested articles as written to suit the state's own control interests](#). A third bill, [authorising ratification of the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime, went to parliament on 28 August with the cybercrime recast](#) and was deferred with it. No resumed date is set and no bill text is published.

Malawi

Two instruments, one passed and one only intended. Parliament [passed the Financial Crimes \(Amendment\) Bill in the week to 6 August](#), which awaits assent; the bill text is not held, so what it changes for digital finance cannot be read off the record. Separately the minister [stated an intention to legislate on artificial intelligence](#), with no draft, scope or timetable behind the statement.

Mali

On 29 July the Garde des Sceaux [instructed all prosecutors, justices of the peace and judicial police to act against networks recruiting through WhatsApp, TikTok and Snapchat](#). The communique enumerates existing penal qualifications and adds that the staging, filming, publication and commentary of such images are themselves offences falling under cybercrime; no new statute was made, no platform was notified, and parents, educators, landlords and hotel keepers are called on to watch and denounce.

On 1 August the Semaine du Numerique's recommendations included [a data-management law and a startups law](#).

Mauritius

The [omnibus introduced on 24 July 2026](#) runs to 119 pages, amends 58 Acts and repeals one, commencing in stages from 1 September 2026. A [secondary account put the figure at some sixty laws](#); the enacting text gives the exact count.

The same bill redraws the virtual-asset perimeter around marketing rather than activity: unlicensed solicitation would be prohibited by any medium, reaching targeted advertising, platforms, social media, influencers, affiliates and referral codes, with any publicly accessible communication presumed to target Mauritius — which puts the burden on an offshore promoter to show it was not soliciting locally.

And on [30 July the ICT minister committed to Electronic Transactions Act amendments](#), with no text or date stated.

The primary text of the [Data Protection Officer Regulations 2026](#) is now held, as Government Notice No. 117 of 2026 made under the Data Protection Act.

A third bill was set out in public rather than in print. The ICT minister said the [Road Traffic \(Amendment\) Bill would make the digital driving licence an official electronic version equivalent to the traditional one and let holders settle fixed traffic penalties at any court and, above all, online](#), putting the affected population at more than 800,000 licence holders and saying the licence depends on interconnecting transport services, law enforcement and public administration. The Bill text is not held and no enactment or commencement date is stated.

Morocco

A 50-article digital health bill was adopted in the government council on 22 July 2026, creating a national health identifier and a shared medical record under a new digitisation agency, with implementing decrees due within 12 months of publication and provider connection within 24 months of the technical decree ([bill account](#)). [Unlawful consultation, use or exchange of personal health data would draw six months to a year and MAD 50,000-200,000.](#)

A constitutional-law academic stated on 30 July that the revised electoral framework criminalises use of artificial intelligence to distort the truth or intrude on the private lives of candidates and voters, naming no law, article number or gazette reference ([commentary](#)).

The data-protection statute is being recast rather than replaced. The regulator's president stated on the record that a recast of law 09-08, developed with the justice ministry, has entered the legislative circuit and been sent to the secretariat general of the government; he describes it as clarification rather than replacement. The [law itself has been in force since 2009](#), and no transmission date or text for the recast is held.

Mozambique

Beyond the Constitutional Council ruling, the month's governance record is the institute's own account of the two 2026 statutes, given at a police academy seminar on 23 July: the Cyber Security Law is Law 13/2026 and the Cybercrime Law is Law 14/2026 ([institute account](#)).

On 28 July the communications minister listed cloud-computing and radio-centre regulations alongside the two 2026 statutes as mandatory for operators of critical infrastructure ([ministerial account](#)).

In August the institute set out what is still missing and what is coming. Its board chairman [said the country has no dedicated artificial-intelligence legislation, and that an Online Copyright Protection Act is in drafting for next year](#), naming authorship of artificial-intelligence output and liability for artificial-intelligence training as open questions no law here answers. The absence of an artificial-intelligence statute is now recorded as a gap; the copyright bill has no draft text, scope or introduction date behind it.

A new Telecommunications and Scarce Resources Licensing Regulation, adopted by decree, [lets the regulator convert operators' fines into universal-service obligations](#) â€” turning a penalty into a coverage commitment. No decree number, entry-into-force date or first conversion is on file.

The regulator's own account of the new licensing regulation is now held, settling the instrument the earlier report named without citing: [Decree 36/2026 on the licensing of telecommunications and scarce resources](#).

Two instruments moved on the same week, one drafting and one made. The labour ministry and the ICT institute [met on 27 August on a targeted Labour Law revision to cover work carried out through digital platforms, with classification of the employment relationship, identifying the employer behind a platform, inspection and algorithmic transparency named as the open questions](#) and no draft text or timetable stated. The Press and Media Law was gazetted as Law 3/2026 of 26 May, revoking the law in force since 1991 and [presented publicly from 28 August for entry into force in December, bringing online-only publications inside the media framework and capping direct and indirect foreign capital in a media organisation at 35 per cent](#); the same supplement of the gazette carries Law 4/2026 on broadcasting and Law 5/2026 on the media council.

Namibia

The Data Protection Bill has not moved. It [is still in finalisation and has not been tabled](#), against the September introduction the ministry had named. The bill has been described as being finalised across successive periods, and the electronic identity rollout it would govern begins in that same month.

Niger

The civil-status reforms are being explained rather than amended. The national awareness tour reached its fourth stage with [a workshop opening in Agadez on the civil-status and personal-identification reforms](#), where [the region mobilised its actors around inclusive governance of the new regime](#). Explaining a reform is not implementing it, and the record held carries no count of registrations made under the new regime in any region the tour has passed through.

Nigeria

On 29 July a claimant won the [first damages award](#) under the Act — ₦15m, ₦500,000 costs and 10% post-judgment interest — against a bank that kept marketing after consent was withdrawn. Liability rested on three instruments at once. The court also held that personal data must be erased on termination but refused wholesale deletion where statutory banking and anti-money-laundering retention applies.

What the amended identity Act actually says reached the record on 11 August, in a law firm's reading rather than a gazetted text. On that reading the [identity commission becomes the root certification authority for a national public key infrastructure and the national biometric-data repository; use of the national identification number is mandatory across passports, banking, telecommunications and land dealings, while the Act states that proof of identity is not proof of eligibility or of citizenship; and unauthorised database access carries at least NGN10m or five years for an individual and NGN20m for a body corporate](#). The base does not hold the Act itself, and the commission's own platform capacity for compulsory use across fourteen sectors is separately recorded as not sized for it.

The bench put its own view on the record. Fifty-four judicial officers [adopted a communique calling for stricter authentication standards for AI-generated evidence and a review of the digital-evidence, cybercrime and privacy statutes](#), naming genuine evidence dismissed as AI-fabricated as an emerging problem, questioning whether clicking agreement is meaningful consent, and asking for electronic case management, virtual hearings and privacy-protected judicial platforms. A communique carries no legal force and no legislative response has followed.

The [ECOWAS Community Court of Justice held that access to the internet is a right within the right to freedom of expression](#), and ordered Nigeria to pay N10 million to the journalist Jide Oyekunle over his assault, detention and phone seizure while covering a protest. The court traced the holding to two of its own earlier judgments, which makes this a settled regional position rather than a first ruling; nothing on file records compliance or payment.

The securities regulator's draft virtual-asset rules were reported in fuller detail on 31 August. They would [require customer assets to be segregated from a firm's own with 80 per cent held offline, minimum paid-up capital of N2bn for digital-asset exchanges and custodians, a fidelity insurance bond covering at least 25 per cent of the applicable minimum, material incidents notified within 24 hours and reported in detail within 48, and SEC approval before a foreign-issued stablecoin may be listed](#). No commencement date or transition period is stated.

Rwanda

The virtual-asset law moved from a rationale approved in principle to an instrument on the books, and the base learned of it only through the regulator's travel. Rwanda [gazetted its first dedicated legislation regulating virtual-asset businesses in May 2026, under which the Capital Market Authority is the primary licensing and supervisory authority for virtual-asset service providers](#). The authority is now benchmarking that framework against the United Arab Emirates', a delegation led by its chief executive [concluding a study tour in the UAE that included a two-day visit to Dubai's Virtual Assets Regulatory Authority, with the two regulators beginning work towards a memorandum of understanding](#) — the UAE side framing it as part of an initiative to expand regulatory partnerships with emerging markets across Africa. No gazette number, licence granted or supervised provider is on record, so what is held is a law reported at second hand and a benchmarking exercise against the jurisdiction it is being modelled on.

Senegal

The critical-infrastructure framework moved from undated draft to adopted law inside the month. The National Assembly [adopted law n° 25/2026 unanimously on 20 August, mandating in-country storage of state-sensitive data, empowering a National Cybersecurity Authority and folding in technology-neutral standards for the artificial-intelligence era and the child-online-protection plan, seven days after reaching the Assembly's intercommission on 13 August](#).

The ministry's own account of the contents grades obligations by risk: [ordinary networks on standard requirements and critical infrastructure on enhanced ones — monitoring, data backup, encryption of sensitive information, business continuity and disaster recovery, and regular resilience testing — against a national authority, a national response team, sectoral teams and cybersecurity operations services](#), with an industrial objective attached: the ministry expects the compliance requirement itself to create accredited providers and skilled jobs.

Every provision is still the ministry's description. The text is not held, no promulgation date or gazette reference is published, and nothing the law creates exists yet.

Sierra Leone

A public-private dialogue was convened [to operationalise the Electronic Transactions Act, in force since December 2019 and never given certification authorities, evidence procedures, dispute mechanisms or penalties](#). It is to produce a gap analysis, a policy memorandum and an implementation roadmap, with no adoption date for any of the three, and worked to [functional equivalence and technological neutrality](#).

The regulator has said the [Subscribers Regulations 2025 will fine operators 25,000 new leones for each unregistered or pre-activated SIM, with a staged disconnection ladder and SIMs matched to National Identification Numbers](#). The six-month transition is presented as running from that announcement, so the phase-out date is unestablished, and the instrument's own text is not held.

Mobile-money fraud reached Parliament. A legal analysis found the [National Communications Authority Act 2022 addresses its enforcement powers to licensees only, with no statutory reversal mechanism, no SIM-swap safeguards and no allocation of loss for authorised push payment fraud](#); a former minister replied that the [central bank's existing know-your-customer rules are adequate and only enforcement is missing](#), identifying no provision by instrument or section. The two accounts have not been reconciled.

A further instrument entered consultation: the Public Financial Management Act 2026 [went to stakeholder consultation in Freetown on 18 August, with digital reforms proposed in it](#). The draft is not published, so which reforms those are cannot be read off the record.

Somalia

The Cybersecurity Law is not yet through parliament. The Upper House [gave a six-chapter, 33-article cybersecurity bill its first reading on 29 August 2026](#), at the first sitting of its eighth term, alongside a separate bill establishing a national meteorological agency. The chamber's [own published procedure requires three readings](#) before a bill passes it.

The House of the People [approved a Cybersecurity Law on 26 January 2026](#), assigning policy to the communications ministry, technical oversight to the regulator and obligations to critical-infrastructure operators. Nothing on file states whether the bill now before the Upper House is that instrument, and neither text is held.

South Africa

The minister [backed the regulator](#) in the review application brought by the two largest mobile operators against the data bundle roll-over rules. The Angolan kwanza became the [second settlement currency on the SADC real-time system](#), the first addition since 2013.

Cross-border crypto acquired a draft rulebook. The Treasury and the central bank [published a draft manual for cross-border crypto activities for comment to 30 September, setting authorisation and reporting rules for crypto asset service providers and defining what counts as a cross-border crypto flow](#), alongside the capital-flow regulations already in draft.

South Sudan

On 5 August 2026 the information minister [briefed the President on establishing an ICT Authority as a state entity under the ICT ministry](#), to regulate internet service providers. The report states the initiative aims to put a regulator in place while the government awaits the passage of legislation through parliament. Neither point that follows is addressed: a body constituted before its statute has no enforcement powers over the providers it is meant to license, and the country already has a National Communication Authority, so the division of competence is unstated. The stated justification is youth employment. An account of 21 May 2026 states that the President signed the Authority's legal framework; the two have not been reconciled.

The other statute in play has a text and a process behind it. The central bank and parliament [opened a five-day workshop on 10 August to validate the National Payment System Bill, 2025](#), covering mobile money, electronic money, payment switches and real-time gross settlement with licensing, consumer-protection and systemic-risk provisions, backed by the East African Community secretariat and the Bank of Uganda. On 17 August the governor [called for faster progress toward passage](#), framing it as the condition for reducing the country's reliance on cash. No bill text, introduction date or parliamentary timetable is held, and the national instant payment system it would license has been Planned since early 2025.

Sudan

A finance-ministry-chaired meeting on 5 August 2026 resolved to review state-to-neighbouring-country trade protocols and refer them to the Council of Ministers, to build a single national legal framework in their place — the stated driver is revenue protection rather than service delivery. [The Council of Ministers reviewed a draft Digital Transformation Law of 2026 on 6 August](#), alongside the cybersecurity and data/AI drafts, and sent it back for further study with no text published. Five days later the justice ministry gave the three a drafting owner: its legal-sector head [said the ministry is preparing the Cybersecurity Regulation Law of 2026, the Data and Artificial Intelligence Regulation Law of 2026 and the Digital Transformation Regulation Law of 2026 in coordination with the digital](#)

[transformation and communications ministry](#), alongside a stated intention to apply the technology to legal services, legislative drafting and smart-justice platforms. No text, timetable or enactment route beyond the joint sitting already on record is published.

Tanzania

The legislative response to all of this is a review rather than a bill. The government says it will [review more than 1,000 laws, including the public-private partnership act, the companies act and financial legislation, to build a regulatory framework supporting artificial intelligence, digital commerce and technology investment](#) under the 2050 development vision. No list of statutes, sequencing, responsible body, timetable or consultation route is stated — and the base still records no online-content or cybercrime regulation for the country, and no adopted artificial-intelligence strategy.

Togo

The month's legislating was about commercial justice and civil status rather than about digital instruments. The National Assembly [adopted bills on commercial-courts reform and on accession to the Hague Apostille Convention in first reading on 14 August](#); the Senate [adopted the courts reform on 21 August](#), and neither promulgation is held. Separately a scoping meeting [opened a review of the 2009 civil registration law to support digital transformation, proposals due before the end of 2026](#). An apostille accession is a digital question in practice: it is the route by which a document issued by one state's register is accepted by another's.

Uganda

Three instruments sit at three stages and none is in force in the window. The Protection of Sovereignty Bill 2026 [carries a central bank technical assessment to joint committees](#), with enactment reported but unconfirmed. The regulator's order suspending public internet [is discontinued, full restoration having been announced in January](#). And the finance ministry [stated at a retreat with parliamentary committees that digital lending platforms will be regulated](#), naming no bill, instrument or date.

Zimbabwe

The regulator ran a notice in the press on 26 July setting mandatory data-protection inspections from 1 September 2026, with a registration threshold of 50 data subjects, licence fees in four tiers, a US\$30 application fee, and journalistic, historical and archival processing exempt from the Act but still required to register ([notice account](#)).

The justice minister told the Senate on 23 July that government has begun implementing the third constitutional amendment, transferring voter registration and management of the roll from the electoral commission to the registrar-general, and characterised the 2013 transfer to the commission as a response to legacy issues now considered resolved; no date, transition plan or safeguard was stated ([Senate account](#)).

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